APPENDIX 4

Prepositional usage

About

to talk about something	*parler de quelque chose*
What are you talking about?	*De quoi parlez-vous?*
What do you know about him?	*Qu'est-ce que vous savez sur son compte?*
What do you know about it?	*Qu'est-ce que vous savez à ce sujet?*
A film/book/article about ---	*Un film/un livre/un article sur . . .*
about (= approximately)	*environ* (INVARIABLE ie it never agrees)
at about 3 o'clock	*vers 3 heures* (NO *à*, and is only used where English has `at about')
it is about 3 o'clock (ie no at)	*il est environ 3 heures*
How about/What about doing something	*Si* + IMPERFECT tense of verb eg *Si on allait/faisait/prenait . . . ?*
What's it about?	*De quoi s'agit-il?*
to wander about the streets	*errer dans les rues*
to wander about the town	*errer par la ville*

Above

above all (= especially)	*surtout*
above + noun	*au-dessus de*
above the fireplace	*au-dessus de la cheminée*
above (without following noun)	*au-dessus*
above (=more than)	*plus de*
There are above 20 soldiers in the street	*Il y a plus de vingt soldats dans la rue*

Across

across (= on the other side of) the street	*de l'autre côté de*
to walk across / go across something	*traverser qch*

After

after + UNIT OF TIME (eg. month)	*au bout de (au bout d'un mois)*
after a while / some time	*au bout de quelque temps (temps is singular)*
after a short while	*au bout de quelques moments*
the day after (her visit)	*le lendemain (de sa visite)*
to take after someone	*tenir de qn*
to ask after someone	*demander des nouvelles de qn*
- I asked after his brother/brothers	*J'ai demandé des nouvelles de son frère / de ses frères*
- I asked after her/him/them	*J'ai demandé de ses / leurs nouvelles*

Along

to walk along (=ALONGSIDE)	*longer qch*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

— he walked along the river	*- il a longé la rivière*
to walk along the road/the path	*marcher sur la route / sur le sentier*
to walk along the street / corridor	*marcher dans la rue / dans le couloir*

Among

among us / among them	*parmi nous / parmi eux*
several among us / among them	*plusieurs d'entre nous / d'entre eux (elles)*
a few among us / among them	*quelques-un(e)s d'entre nous / d'entre eux (elles)*
among the young / the British	*chez les jeunes / chez les Britanniques*

At

i) When `at' follows the verb

to look at something	*regarder qch*
to glare at something	*regarder qch d'un air furieux*
to peep at something	*regarder qch à la dérobée*
to point at something	*montrer qch du doigt*
to laugh at something	*rire de qch*
to marvel at	*s'émerveiller de*
to rush at	*se ruer sur*
to fire / shoot at	*tirer sur*

ii) **miscellaneous**

at the head of	*en tête de*
at home	*chez moi / nous/ vous etc.*
at ease	*à l'aise*
to have something at hand	*avoir qch sous la main*
(seven) at one blow	*(sept) d'un seul coup*
at all costs	*à tout prix or coûte que coûte*
at random	*au hasard*
at war	*en guerre*
at work	*au travail*
at first	*d'abord*
at the same time	*en même temps*
at all events	*de toute façon*
surprised at	*étonné de*
vexed at	*contrarié par*
(3) at once / at a time	*(3) à la fois*
at the rate of (2 a day)	*à raison de (deux par jour)*
at night	*la nuit*

Before

before the eyes of	*sous les yeux de*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

before four o'clock	*avant quatre heures*
before him (in an order)	*avant lui*
before him (physically in front of)	*devant lui*
2 months before / previously	*deux mois auparavant*
the day before (the race)	*la veille de (la course)*
beforehand	*d'avance*
the week / year before	*la semaine / l'année précédente*
nb DISTINGUISH BETWEEN	*avant* **+ noun / pronoun** (eg *avant le petit déjeuner)*
	avant de **+ infinitive**

Behind

behind + noun	*derrière . . .*(Not followed by *de* eg *derrière le mur)*
to be behind in / with one's work	*être en retard dans son travail*
behind the times (= backward)	*arriéré*

Below

below + noun	*au-dessous de (au-dessous de la ville)*
below average	*au-dessous de la moyenne*
below (WITHOUT following noun)	*au-dessous or en dessous*

By

a) to indicate nearness

by (=next to)	*près de*
side by side	*côte à côte*
close by (the window)	*auprès de*

b) to indicate means/cause

killed by ----/stung by ----	*tué par . . . / piqué par . . .*

c) miscellaneous

by chance	*par hasard*
by day (cf. at night)	*le jour (la nuit)*
by means of	*au moyen de*
to learn something by heart	*apprendre quelque chose par coeur*
to judge by appearances	*juger sur les apparences*
by oneself	*tout seul*
by the way	*à propos*
to recognise some one by something	*reconnaître qn à qch*
- I recognised her by the colour of ...	*- Je l'ai reconnue à la couleur de ....*
what time is it by your watch?	*quelle heure avez-vous?*
by tomorrow	*avant demain*
by six o'clock	*avant six heures*
by the time I had finished	*lorsque j'avais fini*
to be paid by the hour/by the month	*être payé à l'heure/au mois*
by bus/car/train	*en voiture/en autobus/ en train*
by bicycle	*à bicyclette or en vélo*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

by mistake	*par erreur*
to be six metres by seven	*mesurer six mètres sur sept*

Down

to go down the street	*marcher dans la rue*
to fall down a hole	*tomber dans un trou*
to be down	*se sentir déprimé or avoir le cafard*

For

a) part of verb

to blame someone for something	*blâmer qn de qch*
to thank someone for something	*remercier qn de qch*
- he thanked her for the present	*- il l'a remerciée du cadeau*
to mistake something for something	*prendre qch pour qch*
to send for something/someone	*envoyer chercher / faire venir qch/qn*
- he sent for her	*- il l'a fait venir* (NB no agreement)

b) Miscellaneous

for example	*par exemple*
to change something for something	*échanger/changer qch contre qch*
to shout for help	*crier au secours*
to make for	*se diriger vers*
to weep for joy	*pleurer de joie*

From

made from milk	:	*fait avec du lait*
from what you say	:	*à ce que vous dites*
from (=with effect/starting from)	:	*à partir de (demain etc)*
from (=right from(childhood etc)	:	*dès l'enfance / dès le premier jour*
a week (from) today	:	*aujourd'hui en huit*
tell them from me that . . .	:	*dites-leur de ma part que . . .*
from + masc. country	:	*du Japon/du Portugal/du Canada*
from + fem. country	:	*de France/de Grèce/d'Allemagne*

In/into translated by à

to take part in	:	*participer à*
to be interested in	:	*s'intéresser à*
I'm very interested in it	:	*je m'y intéresse beaucoup*
to succeed in doing something	:	*réussir à faire qch*
in time (before it is too late)	:	*(arriver) à temps*
to have a pain in (the stomach)	:	*avoir mal à (l'estomac)*
in spring	:	*au printemps*
in the shade	:	*à l'ombre*
in the future	:	*à l'avenir*
in the country(side)	:	*à la campagne*
in May / in August	:	*au mois de mai / au mois d'août*
in bed	:	*au lit*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

in the sun	:	*au soleil*
in my opinion	:	*à mon avis*
in + MASCULINE country	:	*au Danemark/aux Etats-Unis/au Mexique*

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dans/en

in an hour (ie after one hour has elapsed)	:	*dans une heure*
we will leave in one hour	:	*nous partirons dans une heure*
in an hour	:	*en une heure*
(ie the time within which something will happen)		
we can get there in an hour	:	*on peut y arriver en une heure*
in + FEMININE country	:	*en France/en Italie/en Suisse*
to consist of (+ NOUN)	:	*consister en (+ NOUN)*
the village consists of 30 houses	:	*le village consiste en 30 maisons*
to consist in (+ VERB)	:	*consister à (+ INFINITIVE)*
happiness consists in helping others	:	*le bonheur consiste à aider les autres*
to run into (the house)	:	*entrer en courant dans (la maison)*

NB "En" is never followed by a definite article except in the following 4 expressions:

in the air	:	*en l'air*
in the absence of	:	*en l'absence de*
in the year . . .	:	*en l'an . . .*
in honour of	:	*en l'honneur de*

In/Into translated by *de*

to fall in love with	*tomber amoureux (amoureuse) de*
to be dressed in	*être habillé(e) de or être vêtu(e) de*
in a ------ way	*d'une façon ----- or d'une manière ----*
six o'clock in the morning	*six heures du matin*
six o'clock in the evening	*six heures du soir*
in after a SUPERLATIVE	*la plus belle fille de la classe*
	la montagne la plus célèbre du monde

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miscellaneous

in the hands of	*entre les mains de*
in the reign of	*sous le règne de*
in the rain/snow	*sous la pluie / sous la neige*
in the shape of	*sous forme de*

NO preposition

in the morning, afternoon, evening	*l'après-midi, le matin, le soir*

Of

to beware of	*faire attention à*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

of course	*naturellement / bien entendu / bien sûr*
of late	*récemment* **or** *ces derniers temps*
of old / formerly	*autrefois*
to approve of something	*approuver qch* (NO *de*)
He approved of it	*Il l'a approuvé*
to remind someone of something	*rappeler qch à qn*
He reminded her of the problems	*Il lui a rappelé les problèmes*
What has become of him / her?	*Qu'est-il / elle devenu(e)* (NO *de*)*?*
several of us / of them (ie + pronoun)	*plusieurs d'entre nous / d'entre eux/elles*
several of the men (ie + noun)	*plusieurs des hommes*
some of us / them (ie + pronoun)	*quelques-un(e)s d'entre nous / d'entre eux(elles)*
some of the men (women) (ie + noun)	*quelques-un(e)s des hommes (femmes)*

Off

to take off a garment	*enlever* **or** *ôter*
to take off (of aeroplane)	*décoller*
some way off	*à quelque distance d'ici / de là*
I'm off to ------	*je pars pour ------*
a day off	*un jour de congé*
to call off (cancel)	*annuler qch*
to be (called) off	*être annulé(e)*
to take something off the table	*ramasser qch sur la table*
10% off	*une réduction / un rabais de 10%*
to be off duty	*ne pas être de service*
Be off! / Clear off!	*Va-t'en! / Allez-vous-en!* or *File! / Filez!*

On/upon

à

on a bicycle	:	*à bicyclette*
on board ---	:	*à bord de*
on foot (he walked there)	:	*à pied (il y est allé à pied)*
on horseback (to go riding)	:	*à cheval (monter à cheval)*
on purpose	:	*exprès*
on the occasion of / that occasion	:	*à l'occasion de*
on that occasion	:	*à cette occasion*
on the contrary	:	*au contraire*
on the left (right)	:	*à gauche (à droite)*
to knock on a door	:	*frapper à une porte*
to play a trick on someone	:	*jouer un tour à qn*
he played a trick on them	:	*il leur a joué un tour*
on the radio/television	:	*à la radio / à la télévision*
on his / my arrival	:	*à son / mon arrivée* [NB *arrivée* is feminine]
on the telephone	:	*au téléphone*
on time	:	*à l'heure*

de

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

to congratulate someone on something : *féliciter qn de qch*
to depend on : *dépendre de*
to live on something : *vivre de*
to have pity on : *avoir pitié de*
to pride oneself on : *se flatter de*
on duty : *de service*
on the other hand : *en revanche* or *d'autre part*
on this side / on the other side : *de ce côté / de l'autre côté*

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en

on sale : *en vente*
on strike : *en grève*

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on the train/bus/plane/boat : *dans le train/le bus/l'avion/le bateau*
to be hanging on : *être accroché à* (against a wall)
the picture is hanging on the wall : *le tableau est accroché au mur*
[to be hanging from : *être suspendu à*
the lamp is hanging from the ceiling : *la lampe est suspendue au plafond]*
on a fine day / on a wet morning : *par un beau jour / par un matin pluvieux*
on the way (to) : *en route (pour)*
on the way back : *au retour / sur le chemin du retour*
on holiday : *en vacances* [ALWAYS PLURAL]
(a day's holiday) : *(un jour de congé)*
on the ground/floor : *par terre*
to be intent on doing something : *tenir à faire qch*
to call on someone : *passer chez qn* [in this sense *passer* takes *être*]
I called on her : *je suis passé(e) chez elle*

On
where there is no preposition in French

on + date e.g. on 11th May : *le onze mai*
on + day of week e.g. on Sunday : *dimanche*
n.b. on Sundays : *le dimanche*
on the morning/evening of 11th May : *le matin/le soir du onze mai*
to have an operation on something : *se faire opérer de qqch*
She had an operation on her heart *Elle s'est fait opérer du coeur*
to wait on someone : *servir qqn*

Out of : **à bout de**
to be out of patience : *être à bout de patience*
to be out of breath : *être à bout de souffle*

Out of : **hors de**

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

out of action	:	*hors de combat*
out of bounds	:	*hors des limites*
out of breath	:	*hors d'haleine*
out of danger	:	*hors de danger*

Out of : **miscellaneous**

to do something out of something	:	*faire quelque chose par .....*
e.g. out of spite / pity	:	*par méchanceté / par pitié*
to jump/look out of a window	:	*sauter/regarder par une fenêtre*
out of sight out of mind	:	*loin des yeux, loin du coeur*
nine out of ten	:	*neuf sur dix*
out of fashion	:	*démodé(e)*
out of order	:	*en dérangement*
to be out of sorts	:	*être mal en train*
out of print	:	*épuisé*
to be out of work	:	*être en/au chômage*
to sing out of tune	:	*chanter faux* (INVARIABLE)
she sang out of tune		*elle a chanté faux*

Over

over (simple expression of position)	*au-dessus de*
the mirror is over the mantlepiece	*la glace est au-dessus de la cheminée*
over (motion & expressions of vision)	*par-dessus* (nb NO *de*)
he jumped over the wall	*il a sauté par-dessus le mur*
he looked over his shoulder	*il a regardé par-dessus son épaule*
What came over you?	*qu'est-ce qui t'a pris?*
over + expression of quantity	*plus de* (e.g. *plus de mille*)
over the road	*de l'autre côté de la route*
to fly over something	*survoler qch*
over (= beyond) the mountains	*au-delà des montagnes*
to be over (=finished)	*être terminé*
to fall over sthg	*trébucher sur qch*
to knock sthg over	*renverser qch*
there are 4 over (= left)	*il en reste quatre*
to think something over	*réfléchir à qch*
to show someone over something	*faire visiter qch à qn*
to talk things over	*discuter de la situation*

Through

to pass/walk/go through something	*traverser qch*
to get through an exam	*réussir à un examen*
to make one's way through	*se frayer un chemin à travers*
through (= across) the fields	*à travers les champs*
a through train	*un train direct*
to send something through the post	*envoyer qch par la poste*
to go through a red light	*griller / brûler un feu rouge*
to go through (= to search) something	*fouiller qch (e.g. les bagages de qn)*

Towards

motion	*vers*
moral behaviour	*envers*
he is cruel towards his children	*il est cruel envers ses enfants*

other words ending -wards

afterwards	*plus tard*
backwards	*en arrière*
forwards	*en avant*
downwards	*vers le bas*
upwards	*vers le haut*

With

no preposition

to put up with	*supporter qn/qch*

in an expression of temporary posture:	`with' is not translated - French just has the article - see examples below
he came in with his hands behind his back	*il est entré les mains derrière le dos*
.... with a smile on his lips	. . . . . *un sourire aux lèvres*
.... with tears in her eyes	. . . . . *les larmes aux yeux*

à

compared with	*par rapport à*
to compare something with something	*comparer qch à qch*
to shake someone by the hand	*serrer la main à qn*
I shook him by the hand	*je lui ai serré la main*
with open arms	*à bras ouverts*
with the exception of	*à l'exception de*
with the help of	*à l'aide de*

de

to be pleased/happy with	*être content de*
to be disgusted with	*être dégoûté de*
to cover with	*couvrir de*
to sprinkle with	*saupoudrer de*
to be strewn with	*être jonché de*
to be littered with	*être encombré de*
to fill with	*remplir de*
to part with	*se séparer de*
with all my heart	*de tout mon coeur*
to weep with grief	*pleurer de chagrin*

<u>miscellaneous</u>

with a view to doing something	*en vue de faire qch*
to be annoyed with	*être fâché(e) contre* **or** *être irrité(e) contre*
to live / stay with someone	*habiter / rester chez qn*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW